

Nonprofit and NGO English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: nonprofit program managers, NGO staff, grant writers, development officers, monitoring and evaluation teams, field coordinators, volunteer managers, and nonprofit executives

Focus: A nonprofit and NGO English curriculum for donor communication, grants, program evaluation, field operations, safeguarding, community partnerships, volunteer management, and mission-versus-budget tradeoffs.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design

Situation

A donor asks how activities create outcomes.

Stakeholder pressure: Use inspirational stories only.

Constraint: Inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes, assumptions, and evidence need alignment.

Terms to use

- mission
- theory of change
- output
- outcome

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A donor asks how activities create outcomes.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use inspirational stories only.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects theory of change.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a theory-of-change explanation.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects theory of change.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	mission
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use inspirational stories only.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify mission and theory of change against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	We should act now and resolve mission after the result is visible.
C	A theory-of-change explanation is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A donor asks how activities create outcomes. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the theory-of-change explanation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 2. Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions

Situation

A funder offers money for work outside the mission.

Stakeholder pressure: Accept it because funding is scarce.

Constraint: Mission fit, restricted funds, capacity, and reporting obligations need review.

Terms to use

- restricted funding
- deliverable
- grant proposal
- mission fit

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A funder offers money for work outside the mission.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Accept it because funding is scarce.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects deliverable.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a grant-fit recommendation.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects deliverable.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	restricted funding

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Accept it because funding is scarce.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify restricted funding and deliverable against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	A grant-fit recommendation is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A funder offers money for work outside the mission. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the grant-fit recommendation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Module 3. Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning

Situation

A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes.

Stakeholder pressure: Call the program successful.

Constraint: Indicators, baseline, attribution, qualitative evidence, and limitations matter.

Terms to use

- indicator
- baseline
- attribution

- learning agenda

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Call the program successful.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects baseline.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a evaluation caveat paragraph.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects baseline.

Option	Phrase
A	attribution
B	learning agenda
C	indicator
D	baseline

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Call the program successful.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify indicator and baseline against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	We should act now and resolve indicator after the result is visible.
D	A evaluation caveat paragraph is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the evaluation caveat paragraph with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Option	Phrase
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 4. Field Operations and Partner Coordination

Situation

A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline.

Stakeholder pressure: Pressure the partner publicly.

Constraint: Local constraints, safety, community trust, budget, and contingency planning matter.

Terms to use

- implementing partner
- field visit
- contingency
- community trust

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Pressure the partner publicly.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects field visit.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a partner recovery plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects field visit.

Option	Phrase
A	field visit
B	contingency
C	community trust
D	implementing partner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Pressure the partner publicly.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify implementing partner and field visit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partner recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 5. Safeguarding and Incident Reporting

Situation

A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask the staff member informally.

Constraint: Safeguarding policy, confidentiality, survivor-centered response, and investigation process apply.

Terms to use

- safeguarding
- confidentiality
- survivor-centered
- incident report

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask the staff member informally.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects confidentiality.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a safeguarding intake note.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects confidentiality.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	safeguarding
C	incident report
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask the staff member informally.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify safeguarding and confidentiality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the safeguarding intake note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Module 6. Volunteer Management and Training

Situation

Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training.

Stakeholder pressure: Let them help wherever needed.

Constraint: Role scope, training, supervision, risk, and client dignity matter.

Terms to use

- volunteer role
- training
- supervision

- duty of care

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Let them help wherever needed.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects training.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a volunteer boundary script.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects training.

Option	Phrase
A	supervision
B	duty of care
C	volunteer role
D	training

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Let them help wherever needed.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify volunteer role and training against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the volunteer boundary script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	approval path

Option	Phrase
D	operating constraint

Module 7. Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality

Situation

A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic.

Stakeholder pressure: Use it because it gets attention.

Constraint: Source, context, dignity, legal status, and organizational position need review.

Terms to use

- advocacy
- campaign
- dignity
- source

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use it because it gets attention.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects campaign.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a advocacy message review.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects campaign.

Option	Phrase
A	source
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	advocacy

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use it because it gets attention.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A advocacy message review is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

Option	Phrase
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify advocacy and campaign against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve advocacy after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the advocacy message review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	evidence threshold

Module 8. Board Reporting and Sustainability

Situation

Cash runway is tightening while demand rises.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask the board for emergency funds without options.

Constraint: Scenario planning, reserves, restricted funds, staffing, and mission impact need clarity.

Terms to use

- board governance
- cash runway
- reserve
- scenario

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Cash runway is tightening while demand rises.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask the board for emergency funds without options.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects cash runway.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a board sustainability update.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects cash runway.

Option	Phrase
A	scenario
B	evidence threshold
C	board governance
D	reserve

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask the board for emergency funds without options.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify board governance and cash runway against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	We should act now and resolve board governance after the result is visible.
C	A board sustainability update is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Cash runway is tightening while demand rises. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the board sustainability update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. mission	'mission' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify mission and theory of change against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the theory-of-change explanation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. restricted funding	'restricted funding' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify restricted funding and deliverable against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the grant-fit recommendation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. indicator	'indicator' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify indicator and baseline against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the evaluation caveat paragraph with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Field Operations and Partner Coordination - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. implementing partner	'implementing partner' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Field Operations and Partner Coordination - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify implementing partner and field visit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Field Operations and Partner Coordination - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partner recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Safeguarding and Incident Reporting - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. safeguarding	'safeguarding' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Safeguarding and Incident Reporting - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify safeguarding and confidentiality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Safeguarding and Incident Reporting - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the safeguarding intake note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Volunteer Management and Training - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. volunteer role	'volunteer role' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Volunteer Management and Training - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify volunteer role and training against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Volunteer Management and Training - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the volunteer boundary script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. advocacy	'advocacy' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify advocacy and campaign against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the advocacy message review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Board Reporting and Sustainability - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. board governance	'board governance' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Board Reporting and Sustainability - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify board governance and cash runway against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Board Reporting and Sustainability - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the board sustainability update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.